

GSEB CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

Chapter 8: Natural Resources (Soil: Types and Formation) - Section B

SECTION B

Q1. Why is Black soil also known as 'Black Cotton soil'?

- **Moisture Retention:** Black soil has a high capacity to **retain moisture for a long time**.
- **Deep Cracks:** On drying, it develops **deep cracks**, which help in natural loosening of the soil.
- **Fertility:** It is **fertile** and highly suitable for **cotton cultivation**.
- **Reason:** Therefore, black soil is also known as **Black Cotton soil**.

Q2. What is called as Mountain soil?

- **Location:** Mountain soil is found in the **valley and sloping regions of the Himalayas**.
- **Altitude:** It is mainly found at higher altitudes, especially in mountainous regions.
- **Nature:** Its layer is generally **thin and underdeveloped**.
- **Distribution:** It occurs in areas such as **Assam, Darjeeling, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh and Kashmir**.

Q3. Write short note about the Desert soil.

- **Nature:** Desert soil is generally **sandy** and has little organic matter.
- **Climate:** It is found in areas having an **arid or semi-arid climate**.
- **Distribution:** It is found mainly in **Rajasthan, Haryana, Southern Punjab**, and in Gujarat especially **Kachchh** and parts of **Saurashtra**.
- **Agriculture:** With proper **irrigation**, crops such as **millet and jowar** can be grown.

Q4. How many types of soil are there in India? Which are they?

- **Classification:** The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** has classified Indian soils into **8 types**.
- **Types:** **Alluvial soil, Red soil, Black soil and Laterite soil**.
- **More Types:** **Desert soil, Mountain soil, Forest soil and Marshy or Peaty soil**.
- **Basis of Classification:** These types are classified according to features such as **colour, climate, parent rocks, structure and humus**.

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